Appendices

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Appendix A – Phase-1: Survey Copy (Including Summary Descriptions for Part 1, 2, and 3)

A.1. Survey Summary Description

Table 3.1. Survey Part 1 Summary Description

Survey Items and Response Formats for Part 1

Survey Item	Item Wording	Question Type	Response Format
1	Thinking about Artificial Intelligence you may have used or heard of to support academic tasks and your thoughts and experiences around them. From the following list of AI tools, please select any you have used or heard of. We will also ask you to clarify if you have used them for any academic purposes or if you have used them outside of any academic tasks.	Closed-ended	List of 25 AI Tools, 4 options (Academic use; Non-academic use; I have heard of it before but NOT USED it; I have NOT heard of it before but NOT USED it)
2	Have you used another AI tool that we have not included in this list? If so, please specify.	Open-ended	Free-text response box
3	In the last Academic Year, how often did you use AI to support your academic tasks (e.g. writing, proof-reading and editing, as a tutor, translating, summarising, etc.)?	Closed-ended	Drop-down list of 9 ordered options (never – daily or more)
4	In the last Academic Year, how often did you use AI to support non-academic based tasks (e.g. for day to day questions, entertainment like DnD role-play, for advice, creative writing, etc.)?	Closed-ended	Drop-down list of 9 ordered options (never – daily or more)
5	Please name your 5 - 10 most used AI Tools.	Open-ended	Free-text response box

Survey Item	Item Wording	Question Type	Response Format
6	What type of tasks have you used AI for (e.g. drafting email communication, time management etc.)? Please name as many as you can think of.	Open-ended	Free-text response box
7	Are there any particular struggles you have in your academic work or outside your academic work that you have not found an AI tool to support you with?	Open-ended	Free-text response box

Table 3.2. Survey Part 2 Summary Description

Survey Items and Response Formats for Part 2

Survey Item	Item Wording	Question Type	Response Format
8	What do you think are the benefits in using AI tools, in academic tasks and outside of them?	Open-ended	Free-text response box
9	What have you found most useful when using AI tools?	Open-ended	Free-text response box
10	What do you think are some of the barriers to using AI tools?	Open-ended	Free-text response box
11	In a perfect world, what type of tasks or activities would you like support with, whether from someone else or something that can help you do them faster or do them for you? Please explain why that is.	Open-ended	Free-text response box
12	Do you think there are aspects of using AI tools that could be particularly useful for neurodivergent individuals? Why?	Open-ended	Free-text response box
13	Are there other functions or uses of AI you would like to learn more about with some guidance?	Open-ended	Free-text response box
14	Is there anything else you would like to share about a potential connection between using AI tools and being neurodivergent that we have not asked you yet?	Open-ended	Free-text response box

Table 3.3. Survey Part 3 Summary Description

Survey Items and Response Formats for Part 3

Survey Item	Item Wording	Question Type	Response Format
15	What is your age in years?	Closed-ended	Free-text response box, content restricted to numbers (1 – 200)
16	What is your current gender identity?	Mixed: open- and close-ended	List of 5 options (Male; Female; Non-binary; I describe my gender in another way; Prefer not to say) A free-text response box for "Please specify"
17	What is your position in the University?	Mixed: open- and close-ended	List of 4 options (Staff; Student; Professional Services; Other, please state) A free-text response box for "Other, please state"
18	Are you neurodivergent? Note: By neurodivergent we consider the main paradigm that encompasses Autism, ADHD, AuDHD, Dyspraxia, Dyslexia, other learning difficulties and OCD. You also do not need to have a clinical diagnosis to prove your status, **self-diagnosis is accepted**.	Mixed: open- and close-ended	List of 3 options (Yes; No; Prefer not to say) A free-text response box for "Please specify"
19	Which of these best describes your ethnic group?	Mixed: open- and close-ended	List of 34 options (Prefer not to say; Indian; Pakistani; Bangladeshi; Chinese; East Asian (other than Chinese); South Asian (other than Indian, Pakistani, or

Survey Item	Item Wording	Question Type	Response Format
			Bangladeshi); Southeast Asian; Central Asian; Middle Eastern; Any other Asian background; Caribbean; North African; West African; East African; Central African; Southern African (e.g. South African, Zimbabwean, etc.); Any other Black, Black British, Caribbean or African background; English, Welsh, Scottish, Northern Irish or British; Irish; European; Any other White background; White and Black Caribbean; White and Black African; White and Asian; Any other Mixed or Multiple ethnic background; Native American or First Nations; Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander; Pacific Islander; Any other Indigenous background; Arab; Latin American; Gypsy, Roma or Traveller; Other ethnic background) A free-text response box for "Please specify"

A.2. Survey Copy

A.2.1. Main Survey (Prolific Version)

Note. There were two versions of the main survey; a Prolific and non-Prolific survey. The only difference between them being that the Prolific survey automatically collected a Prolific ID (due to the redirection from Prolific to the Qualtrics survey) and asked screening questions to ensure participants were at least 18 years old, a staff or student at a UK university, and neurodivergent before gaining access to the survey.

The following is a copy of the Prolific survey:

What is your Prolific ID?

(Please note that this response should auto-fill with the correct ID)

${e://Field/PROLIFIC_PID}

Are you Neurodivergent?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Are you a university staff or student in the UK?

- ○ Student
- ○ Staff
- ○ I do not work/study in a University in the UK
- ○ Study and work at a UK University

Are you over 18 and living in the UK?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

University of Glasgow | College of Medical, Veterinary & Life Sciences

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET

Exploring how to engage effectively with AI tools to support neurodiversity in staff and students

Research Team:
Dr Alexia Revueltas Roux, Dr Steph Sayan, Dr Helena Paterson, Dr Sarune Savickaite, Jade Burke, Sara Eftekhari

You are invited to participate in a research study on your experiences using Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools to assist your learning. We appreciate that you are considering taking part in our study. Before you proceed further, it is important to understand why this research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish. Please do not hesitate to contact us if you have any questions or require any further information.

What is the study about?

AI tools are increasingly prominent in our technological landscape. AI aims to reduce the workload of different tasks and facilitate access to knowledge and skills. The effective use of AI tools may be of particular benefit to neurodivergent students and staff, who could face multiple challenges through their learning and academic journeys.

Neurodiversity (ND) is an umbrella term encompassing a range of experiences, such as autism, attention deficit hyperactivity disorder and dyslexia, as well as neurotypically developed individuals. This project aims to explore the potential of AI to support neurodivergent students and staff by collecting examples of how to use AI in a self-directed manner as a learning assistant. This project aims to co-develop a 'tool-box' of resources to support learning and teaching in the School of Psychology and Neuroscience along with members of the Neurodiversity Network. The first step is understanding how AI tools are being used and exploring available tools. If you decide to take part, we will ask you to

answer some questions to discuss your experiences using AI tools.

Do I have to take part?

No, it is completely up to you to decide whether or not you want to take part. Your participation in this study is completely voluntary and confidential. If you agree to take part in the study, you will be asked to provide electronic consent to take part and all your data will be collected electronically.

If at any stage of the study, you feel uncomfortable and would like to terminate your participation, there is no obligation to continue and you can withdraw from the study at any point by just closing the browser. However, once the data has been submitted, because we do not record your name, this cannot be deleted and we will retain the data completed up to the point of withdrawal. However, we will not share it as examples or when making part of the data available to other researchers. If you wish to participate in additional projects with us, we will leave a space for you to write your email address, this is not mandatory or needed to take part in the research. The email address will not be linked to your responses. At your request, we can delete your email address from our database at any point after submitting the data.

Am I eligible to take part?

You will be eligible to take part in the study if you consider yourself to be neurodivergent, if you are 17 or over and you are a student or member of staff in any UK University. If you are 16 years old or under, please close your browser now.

What will my participation involve?

You will be asked to fill out an anonymous survey that asks about your thoughts and experiences around different AI tools, whether you have used them or not. If you decide to take part in our study, you will be asked the following data about yourself: age, gender, if you are staff or a student, and if you are neurodivergent. The survey should take about 20-25 minutes. At the end, we will ask you to volunteer your email address if you wish to take part in additional research projects with us, which will not be linked in any way to any of your responses.

Will my participation be kept confidential?

The study is conducted using online software that complies with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which ensures that your data remains confidential and only accessible to the research team in the first instance. When completing the study, your responses will be stored

with an anonymous participant identification number, we will not ask you for your name, school, or any other personal identifying data, your name will not appear at any point once the data has been collected. This means that after you have submitted your answers, we will have no way of identifying specific responses. If you decide to provide an email address, this will be stored separately, and no survey response will be linked to your email. Therefore, once you submit your responses you can no longer withdraw from the study.

At the end of the survey, we will ask your permission to share your responses for future research as part of a secondary data repository, where data can be uploaded and stored for future use by other researchers. Please note that as the survey has free-response data and questions pertaining to formal diagnoses of neurodivergence, it may be possible that you can be identified from the answers and special category information about you may become public, even if you do not share your name.

However, if you do not consent to us adding your data to an online repository we will remove it from the dataset before making it public and will not include quotes in any publications or presentations. Your data will still form part of our analysis and we will share summary data in reports and presentations.

What will happen to my data?

All study data will be held in accordance with GDPR (2018). Your rights to access, change or move the information we store may be limited, as we need to manage your information in specific ways for the research to be reliable and accurate. If you withdraw from the study by leaving the dataset incomplete, we will keep the information about you that we have already obtained and use it for analysis, but not share it. To safeguard your rights, we will use the minimum personally-identifiable information possible, and the protected characteristic being asked will be safely stored and will not be used or triangulated against any other information we hold from you or that the university may hold. The data will be in GDPR-compliant cloud storage (OneDrive) linked to Helena Paterson. Your email (if you choose to provide it) will be accessible to the research team only until they have recruited participants for the next phase of the project and will be deleted no later than June 30 2025. The remaining data will be archived and stored indefinitely or until Helena Paterson leaves the institution and her account is deleted. However, if you have provided your email for the follow-up study, this will be stored in a separate folder until the interviews have been conducted, after this the information will be deleted.

If you consent, we will use anonymised quotes from your answers as part of our tool-kit guides, as well as for scientific conferences and publishing of the research, and will include it as part of the public dataset to share in an online data repository so it can be used for future research by other researchers.

Please note, that during the transcription process, any potentially identifiable information, e.g. age, ethnicity, University-affiliation, etc. will be redacted during the transcription phase. Only anonymized information will be used in publications or presentations mentioned above.

What will happen to the results of the research study?

All the data that we collect will be analysed confidentially and we will make summary data available in reports and presentations. The findings of the study will be used for the purposes of developing guidance and a 'tool-kit' of resources for individuals who identify as neurodivergent. With your consent, we may use some of your answers verbatim as quotes in publications. If you would like a summary of the results, this can be provided to you upon request from the researchers.

What are the possible disadvantages or risks of taking part in the study?

There are no present disadvantages to taking part in this study. There is a very low risk that you could be identified by some of the demographic data and answers that you provide, however, we are not asking for any identifying information such as name, University, School or Department to minimise this risk. However, if at any point you feel uncomfortable or would not like to continue with the study, please close the browser. Note that all data entered thus far will kept, however, we will not share it.

Are there any benefits or monetary incentives for taking part?

There is the opportunity to receive £3.50 in compensation for your contribution via the Prolific platform. The account in Prolific is in no way traced or aligned with the survey data and your anonymous answers cannot be linked to your profile.

If you would like to take part without making a Prolific account, you can do so, however, given the anonymous design of the survey, we cannot provide compensation this way.

You will also be provided with a list of AI Tools and their online links to explore at your leisure after finishing this study.

Additionally, the information you provide us during this study will help us understand better the lived experiences of neurodivergent staff/students on their use of AI tools to create resources where we can best support their different needs.

Who is organising and funding the research?

A University of Glasgow Staff-Student Partnership award is funding this research.

Who has reviewed the study?

The project has been reviewed by the College of Medical, Veterinary & Life Sciences Ethics Committee.

Who can I contact if I want more information?

If you have any questions regarding our study or you would like a summary of the results, please do not hesitate to contact the research team leads.

Contact details:

Dr Alexia Revueltas Roux – alexia.revueltasroux@glasgow.ac.uk
Dr Steph Sayan – steph.sayan@glasgow.ac.uk
Jade Burke – jade.burke@glasgow.ac.uk

PRIVACY NOTICE

Exploring how to engage effectively with AI tools to support neurodiversity in staff and students

The **University of Glasgow** will be what's known as the 'Data Controller' of your personal data processed in relation to this research study titled "Exploring how to engage effectively with AI tools to support neurodiversity in staff and students". This privacy notice will explain how The University of Glasgow will process your personal data.

Why we need it:
We are collecting your basic personal data such as your age, gender and neurodiversity status for the purpose of basic research and to describe you based on broad categories, but not to identify you in any way. We will only collect the minimum amount of data required for these purposes to minimise the risk of you being identified. If you supply an email, we will use that to contact you with an invitation to a future part of the study.

Legal basis for processing your data:
In the context of research, the lawful basis upon which we will process your personal data is usually where "Processing is necessary for the performance of a task carried out in the public interest or in the exercise of official authority vested in the controller" (Article 6 of UK GDPR). We will also process personal data as permitted by Article 9, of the UK GDPR which permits processing necessary data for archiving purposes in the public interest, scientific or historical research purposes or statistical purposes which shall be proportionate to the aim pursued, respect the essence of the right to data protection and provide for suitable and specific measures to safeguard the fundamental rights and the interests of the data subject. Where we need to rely on a different legal condition, such as consent, we will inform you of this in the Participant Information provided to you.

What we do with it and who we share it with:
All the personal data you submit within this project is processed by the research team named above who are staff at the University of Glasgow in the United Kingdom. Unless you consent to your data being made public, it will not be sent outside the UK for any purposes at any time.

Throughout the project and during the archiving period all data will be stored on password-protected University servers.

How long do we keep it for:
Your anonymised data will be retained by the University for archiving purposes indefinitely on a OneDrive account linked to Helena Paterson and will be securely deleted when she leaves the institution. If you supply an email, we will delete this no later than 30 June 2025.

What are your rights?*
Under the UK GDPR, you have the following rights:

- to obtain access to, and copies of, the personal data that we hold about you;
- to require that we cease processing your personal data if the processing is causing you damage or distress;
- to require us to correct the personal data we hold about you if it is incorrect;
- to require us to erase your personal data;
- to require us to restrict our data processing activities;
- to receive from us the personal data we hold about you which you have provided to us, in a reasonable format specified by you, including for the purpose of you transmitting that personal data to another data controller;
- to object, on grounds relating to your particular situation, to any of our particular processing activities where you feel this has a disproportionate impact on your rights.

Your rights to access, change (rectify), or remove your information (erasure) may be limited, as we need to manage your information in specific ways for the research to be reliable and accurate. If you withdraw from the study, we may not always be able to remove the information that we have already obtained. We must comply with a request to erase personal data or to rectify personal data that is inaccurate unless there are grounds for refusing the request specified in the UK GDPR. To safeguard your rights, we will use the

minimum personally-identifiable information possible.

The Participant Information Sheet given to you will detail up to what point in the study data can be withdrawn as it may be anonymised after a certain point and thus no longer distinguishable as yours.

If you wish to exercise any of these rights, please submit your request via the webform or contact dp@gla.ac.uk

* Please note that the ability to exercise these rights will vary and depend on the legal basis on which the processing is being carried out.

Complaints:

If you wish to raise a complaint about how we have handled your personal data, you can contact the University Data Protection Officer who will investigate the matter.

Our Data Protection Officer can be contacted at dataprotectionofficer@glasgow.ac.uk

If you are not satisfied with our response or believe we are not processing your personal data in accordance with the law, you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) https://ico.org.uk/

CONSENT FORM

Exploring how to engage effectively with AI tools to support neurodiversity in staff and students

Research Team:

Dr Alexia Revueltas Roux, Dr Steph Sayan, Dr Helena Paterson, Dr Sarune Savickaite, Jade Burke, Sara Eftekhari

I confirm that I have fully read and understood the Participant Information Sheet.
I understand that my participation is for research purposes only and not for evaluating me as an individual.
I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw at any time, without giving any reason, without my legal rights being affected. I can do that by simply closing the browser.
I understand that if I withdraw from the study, my data collected up to that point will be retained and used for the remainder of the study.
I confirm that I agree to the way my data will be collected and processed and that data will be stored indefinitely in University archiving facilities in accordance with relevant Data Protection policies and regulations.
I understand that if I provide my e-mail for future contact this will not be stored with or connected to my provided data in any way.
I agree to take part in the study.

Please confirm that you agree with the information provided, and that you consent to the terms above.

- ○ Yes, I have read the Participant Information Sheet, Privacy Notice and Consent Form and AGREE to take part in this study.
- ○ No, I do NOT CONSENT to take part. The study will finish here.

Main Survey Questions

Part 1: Your Use of AI Tools

This section is about how you have used or experienced any AI tools.

Remember, your answers are **anonymous**. All your data will be safely stored and will not be triangulated against any other information we hold from you or that the university may hold.

Thinking about Artificial Intelligence you may have used or heard of to support academic tasks and your thoughts and experiences around them.

From the following list of AI tools, please select any you have used or heard of. We will also ask you to clarify if you have used them for any academic purposes or if you have used them outside of any academic tasks.

	Academic Use	Non-academic Use	I have heard of it before but NOT USED it	I have NOT heard of it before and NOT USED it
ChatGPT	☐	☐	☐	☐
ClickUp	☐	☐	☐	☐
Connected Papers	☐	☐	☐	☐
Copilot	☐	☐	☐	☐
DeepL	☐	☐	☐	☐
Elicit	☐	☐	☐	☐

Fireflies.ai	☐	☐	☐	☐
Gamma	☐	☐	☐	☐
Gemini	☐	☐	☐	☐
goblin.tools	☐	☐	☐	☐
Grammarly	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hemingway Editor	☐	☐	☐	☐
Jasper	☐	☐	☐	☐
Litmaps	☐	☐	☐	☐
Motion	☐	☐	☐	☐
Notion	☐	☐	☐	☐

Otter.ai	☐	☐	☐	☐
Perplexity	☐	☐	☐	☐
ProWritingAid	☐	☐	☐	☐
Quillbot	☐	☐	☐	☐

Research Rabbit	☐	☐	☐	☐
Scholarcy	☐	☐	☐	☐
Scite	☐	☐	☐	☐
Slick Write	☐	☐	☐	☐
Zoom AI Companion	☐	☐	☐	☐

Have you used another AI tool that we have not included in this list? If so, please specify.

In the last Academic Year, how often did you use AI to support your academic tasks (e.g. writing, proof-reading and editing, as a tutor, translating, summarising, etc.)?

In the last Academic Year, how often did you use AI to support non-academic based tasks (e.g. for day to day questions, entertainment like DnD role-play, for advice, creative writing, etc.)?

Please name your 5 - 10 most used AI Tools.

What type of tasks have you used AI for (e.g. drafting email communication, time management etc.)? Please name as many as you can think of.

Are there any particular struggles you have in your academic work or outside your academic work that you have not found an AI tool to support you with?

Part 2: Your Perceptions of using AI Tools

This section is about what you think around the use of AI tools.

Remember, your answers are **anonymous**. All your data will be safely stored and will not be triangulated against any other information we hold from you or that the university may hold.

What do you think are the benefits in using AI tools, in academic tasks and outside of them?

What have you found most useful when using AI tools?

What do you think are some of the barriers to using AI tools?

In a perfect world, what type of tasks or activities would you like support with, whether from someone else or something that can help you do them faster or do them for you? Please explain why that is.

Do you think there are aspects of using AI tools that could be particularly useful for neurodivergent individuals? Why?

Are there other functions or uses of AI you would like to learn more about with some guidance?

Is there anything else you would like to share about a potential connection between using AI tools and being neurodivergent that we have not asked you yet?

Part 3: Demographics Questions

We'd like to know a little bit more about yourself. Having this information will be useful in our research.

Remember, your answers are **anonymous**. All data, including your protected characteristics, will be safely stored and will not be triangulated against any other information we hold from you or that the university may hold.

What is your age in years?

What is your current gender identity?

- ○ Male
- ○ Female
- ○ Non-binary
- ○ I describe my gender in another way
  Please specify:
- ○ Prefer not to say

What is your position in the University?

- ○ Staff
- ○ Student
- ○ Professional Services
- ○ Other, please state

Are you neurodivergent?

Note: By neurodivergent we consider the main paradigm that encompasses Autism, ADHD, AuDHD, Dyspraxia, Dyslexia, other learning difficulties and OCD. You also do not need to have a clinical diagnosis to prove your status, **self-diagnosisisaccepted**.

- ○ Yes

  Please specify:

- ○ No
- ○ Prefer not to say

Which of these best describes your ethnic group?

- ○ Prefer not to say

Asian or Asian British

- ○ Indian
- ○ Pakistani
- ○ Bangladeshi
- ○ Chinese
- ○ East Asian *(other than Chinese)*
- ○ South Asian *(other than Indian, Pakistani, or Bangladeshi)*
- ○ Southeast Asian
- ○ Central Asian
- ○ Middle Eastern
- ○ Any other Asian background

  Please specify:

  [ ]

Black, Black British, Caribbean or African

- ○ Caribbean
- ○ North African
- ○ West African
- ○ East African
- ○ Central African
- ○ Southern African (e.g. South African, Zimbabwean, etc.)
- ○ Any other Black, Black British, Caribbean or African background

Please specify:

White

- ○ English, Welsh, Scottish, Northern Irish or British
- ○ Irish
- ○ European
- ○ Any other White background

Please specify:

Mixed or Multiple Ethnic Group

- ○ White and Black Caribbean
- ○ White and Black African
- ○ White and Asian
- ○ Any other Mixed or Multiple ethnic background

Please specify:

Indigenous Peoples

- ○ Native American or First Nations
- ○ Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander
- ○ Pacific Islander
- ○ Any other Indigenous background

Please specify:

Other Ethnic Groups

- ○ Arab
- ○ Latin American
- ○ Gypsy, Roma or Traveller
- ○ Other ethnic background

Please specify:

Secondary Data & Phase-2

Before we finish...

Please reflect on your responses and whether there is anything in the answers that you provided that you feel is personal and that you would not want the public to know about you. Then tick all that apply from the following statements:

- ☐ You can use my responses as quotes in a redacted format for any resources, publications or presentations that result from this research
- ☐ You can share my survey responses with other scientists via a public data repository (such as the OSF, Figshare or GitHub)
- ☐ Please do not use quotes from my data or share it as part of the public dataset

Are you interested in participating in follow-up studies with us (e.g. qualitative interviews, focus groups)? We aim to refine and evaluate our toolbox with your insight.

- ○ Yes, I am interested.
- ○ No, I am NOT interested.

DEBRIEF

You have completed this study. Thank you for taking the time to participate in this research.

*After reading this debrief, make sure you get redirected to Prolific or your participation will not be registered automatically.

This study explores the potential of AI tools to support neurodivergent students and staff. By collecting examples of how neurodivergent people with lived experiences use AI in a self-directed manner to support their academic workload. This is still a very new and exciting area of research, and we considered getting lived experience from neurodivergent staff and students from UK institutions would allow us to understand directly what the experiences and needs may be.

We anticipate that neurodivergent students and staff, who may encounter multiple challenges in their learning and academic journeys, such as executive dysfunction, planning, emotional taxation on asking for clarification/support, etc., could particularly benefit from the effective use of AI tools.

The findings of this study will be used to co-develop a toolbox of resources on how different AI tools can support particular tasks that benefit learning and teaching in our School of Psychology and Neuroscience and other Higher Education Institutions by sharing our resources openly. We also aim to evaluate the toolbox with future qualitative interviews and re-evaluate the tools in a couple of years. Additionally, the findings will contribute to a report for the Learning and Teaching Conference at the University of Glasgow and may be used for further publications and scientific dissemination of the findings and outputs.

Here is the list of AI tools you have been asked about in our survey. These include links to each of the websites. If you would like to receive a copy in your e-mail let the research team know.

** Please note not all of these are free, GDPR compliant, and may have other considerations to consider. These were compiled from some of our research and word of mouth. We are not directly recommending them yet as we have not tried them all ourselves. We strongly suggest looking more into them before using them.*

If you would like a summary of the results, this can be provided upon request from the researchers. We understand the importance of your time and effort in contributing to this study. Remember that as a token of our appreciation, you will be compensated £3.50 via your Prolific account. In order to do this, make sure you have made it to the end of this study, where you will be automatically redirected to the Prolific website where your participation will be confirmed.

For any other questions regarding your participation in this research, the use of your data, ethical issues, results of the study or any other information, feel free to contact the research team leads:

Dr Alexia Revueltas Roux – alexia.revueltasroux@glasgow.ac.uk

Dr Steph Sayan – steph.sayan@glasgow.ac.uk

Jade Burke – jade.burke@glasgow.ac.ukThank you again for taking part in our study!

*If you have chosen to take part in future studies, we will collect your e-mail before redirecting you to Prolific.

Powered by Qualtrics

A.2.2. Email Collection

Note. Like the main survey, there were two versions of the email collection survey; a Prolific and non-Prolific version. The only difference between being slight wording differences to sign-post that participants would be redirected to Prolific to receive their £3.50 compensation. Participants were only redirected to a version of the email collection survey if they agreed to participate in Phase-2.

The following is a copy of the Prolific email collection survey:

Thank you for your interest in taking part in further studies with us.

We just want to reassure you that this will be kept separate and will not be connected to any of your previous responses.

What is your e-mail address?

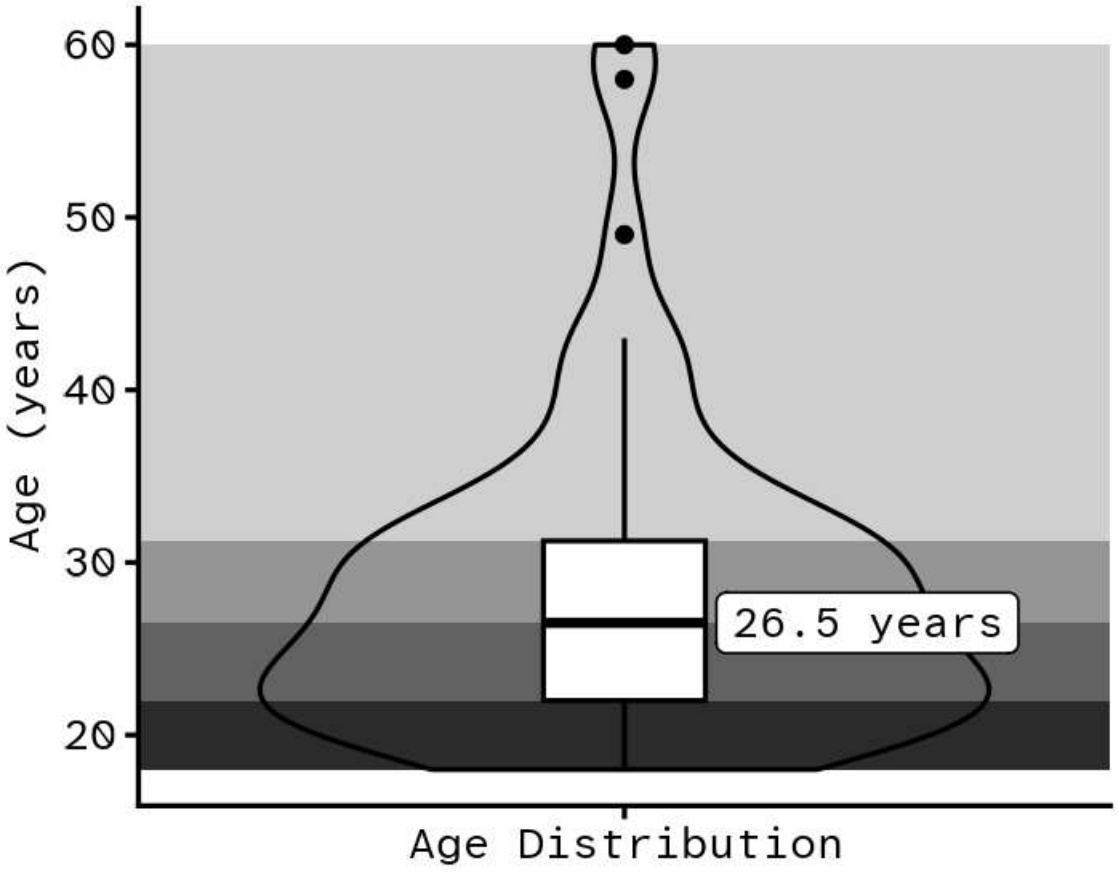
Thank you! We will add you to our database.

Remember you will be redirected to Prolific to automatically register your participation, please click on the arrow to finish

Powered by Qualtrics

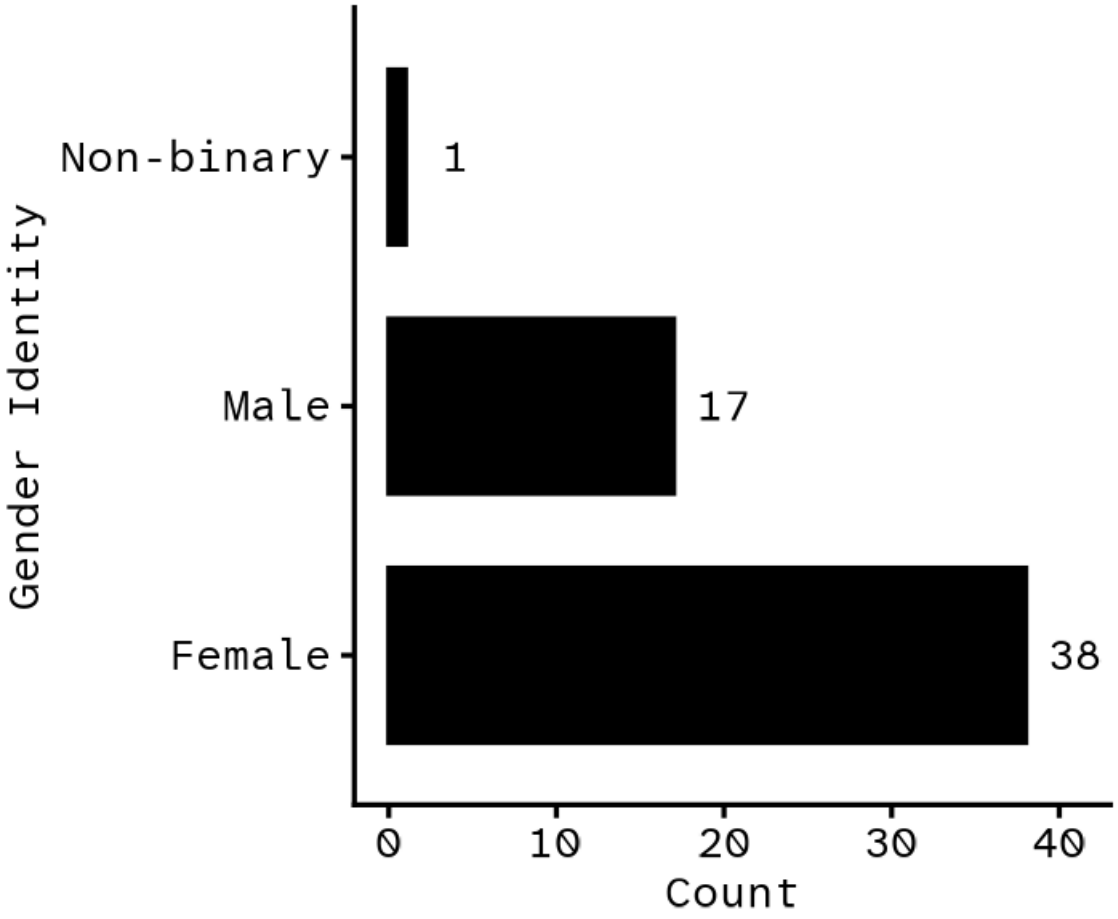
Appendix B – Phase-1: Demographic Figures

Figure 2.1. Age Distribution



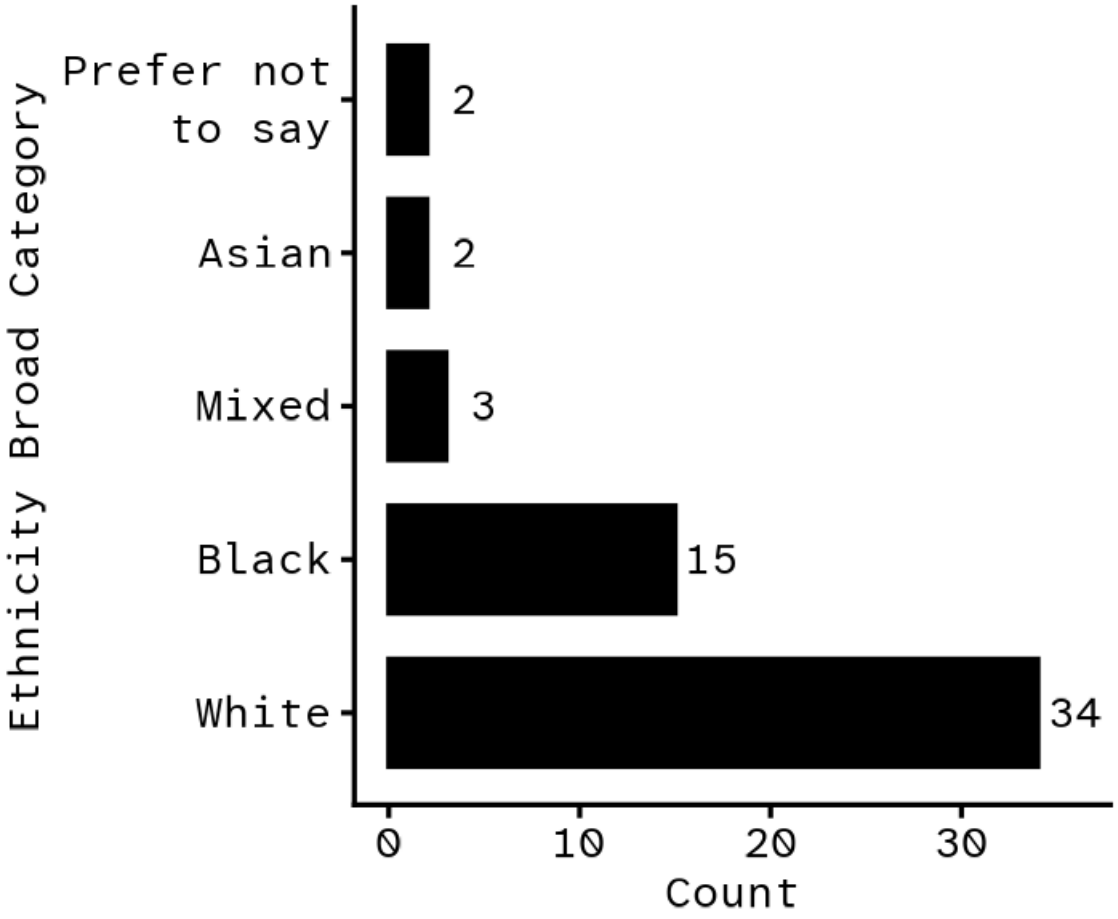
Note. Participant age distributions were positively skewed towards those in their early 20s to early 30s (*Med age* = 26.5 years; *IQR age* = 22–31.3 years). Numbers rounded to one decimal place.

Figure 2.2. Gender Identity Count



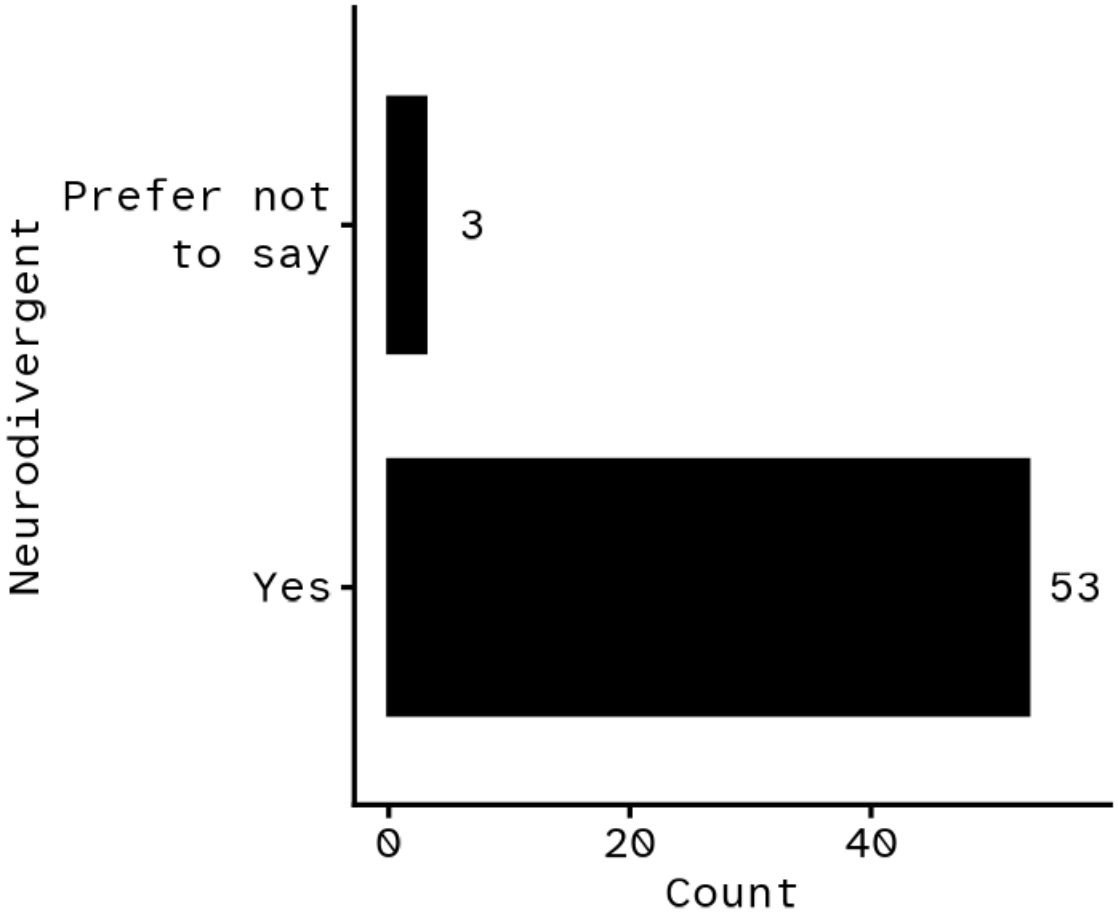
Note. Participants most commonly chose 'Female' (n = 38) to describe their gender identity; 17 chose 'Male' and 1 'Non-binary'.

Figure 2.3. Ethnic Background Count



Note. Participants mainly chose options falling under the 'White' (n = 34) and 'Black' (n = 15) superordinate ethnic categories.

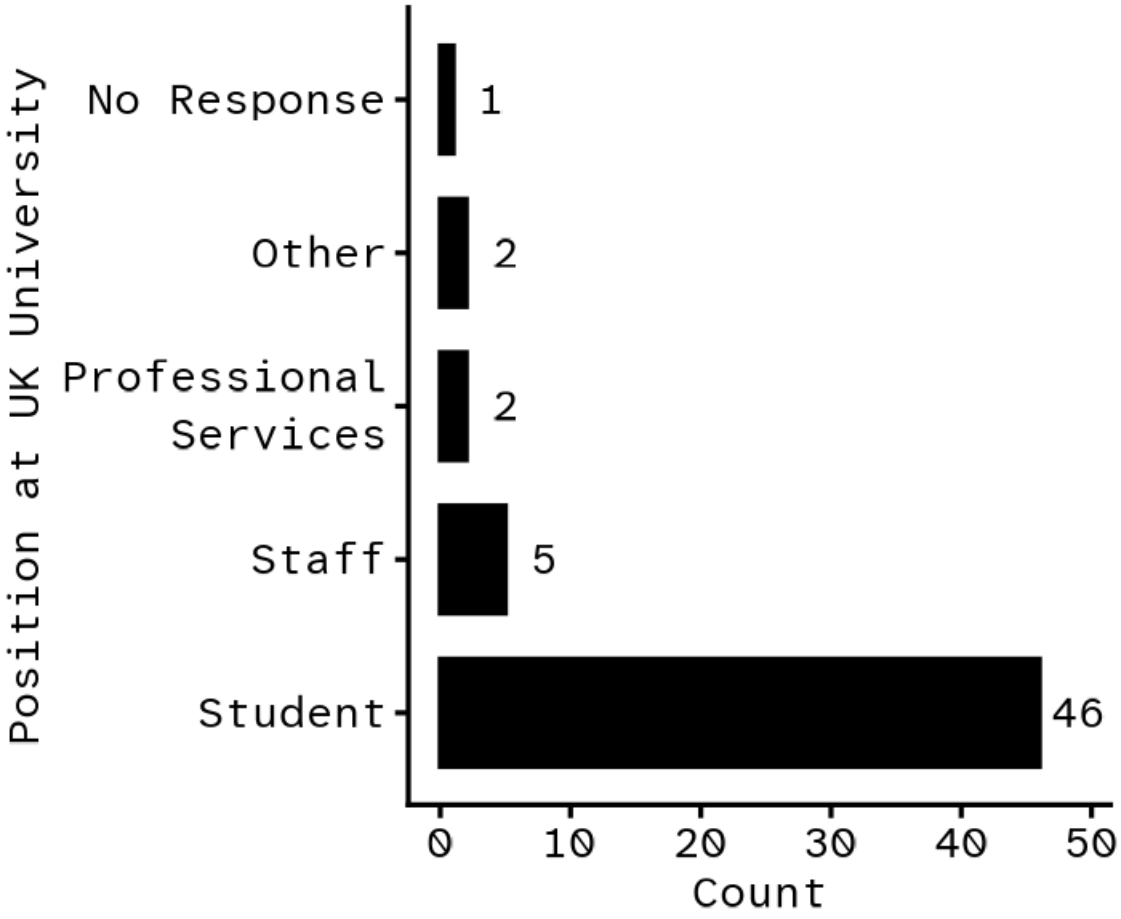
Figure 2.4. Neurodivergent Status Count



Note. Almost all (n = 53) participants responded 'Yes' to being neurodivergent. Participants were informed that self-diagnosis is accepted, and given examples such as Dyslexia, ADHD, OCD, etc. to define neurodivergence.

All the participants answering 'Prefer not to say' (n = 3) were recruited through Prolific where screener questions were asked, and only those who were neurodivergent were allowed to progress unto the survey. No participants recruited through other (non-Prolific) means answered 'Prefer not to say' to whether they self-reported as neurodivergent or not.

Figure 2.5. Position at UK University Count



Note. The majority (n = 46) of participants self-reported as a 'Student' at a UK University.

Appendix C – Phase-1: Result Figures & Tables

Table 4. Exclusion/Inclusion Criteria Count

A Count of Responses Removed During Data Cleaning

Removal Order	**Description of What Was Removed**	***n* Removed During**	***n* Remaining After**
0	Raw data (no removals)	NA	169
1	Including only neurodivergent responses	0	169
2	Removing preview/test responses	86	83
3	Including only those who consented to participation	13	70
4	Including only completed responses	8	62
5	Removing empty/NA responses	1	61
6	Removing duplicate responses	0	61
7	Removing suspiciously uniform/mismatched responses	0	61
8	Removing suspected AI generated open text responses	5	56

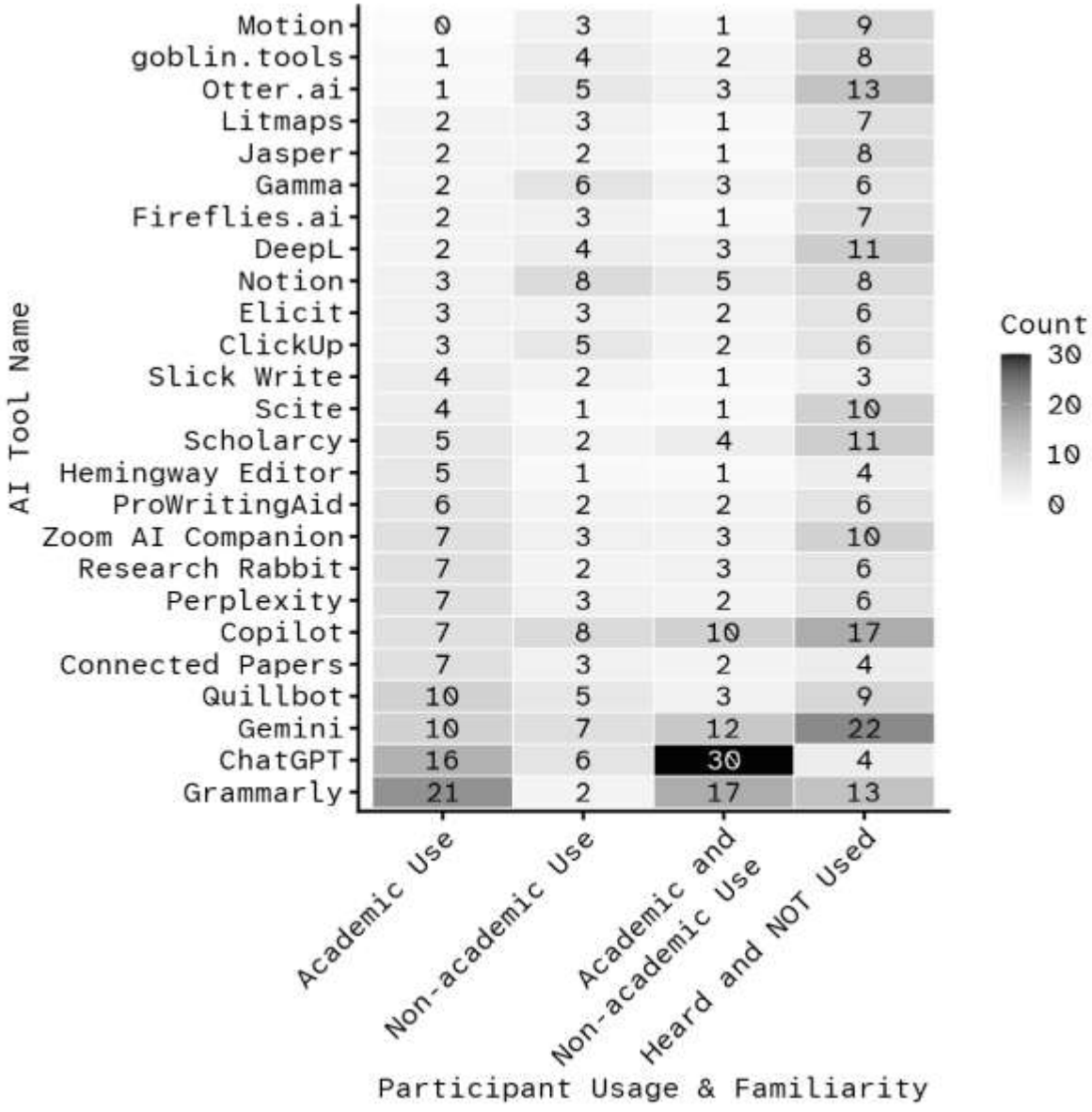
Note. The surveys were anonymous. We assumed in good faith that each unique ResponseId denotes one participant. Theoretically it is possible that a participant may have submitted multiple responses, each with their own unique ResponseId.

Participants were informed that self-diagnosis is accepted, and given examples such as Dyslexia, ADHD, OCD, etc. to define neurodivergence. All the participants answering "Prefer not to say" ($n = 3$) were recruited through Prolific where screener questions were asked, and only those who were neurodivergent were allowed to progress unto the survey. No participants recruited through other (non-Prolific) means answered "Prefer not to say" to whether they self-reported as neurodivergent or not.

Responses were manually checked for any unusual uniformity (i.e. if a participant selected the same option for the AI tools matrix throughout, perhaps to quickly finish the survey), and for whether if the Part 1 and Part 2 of the survey answers matched logically (e.g. a mismatch is if a participant answered that they rarely/never use AI, but then in Part 2 mention they use it).

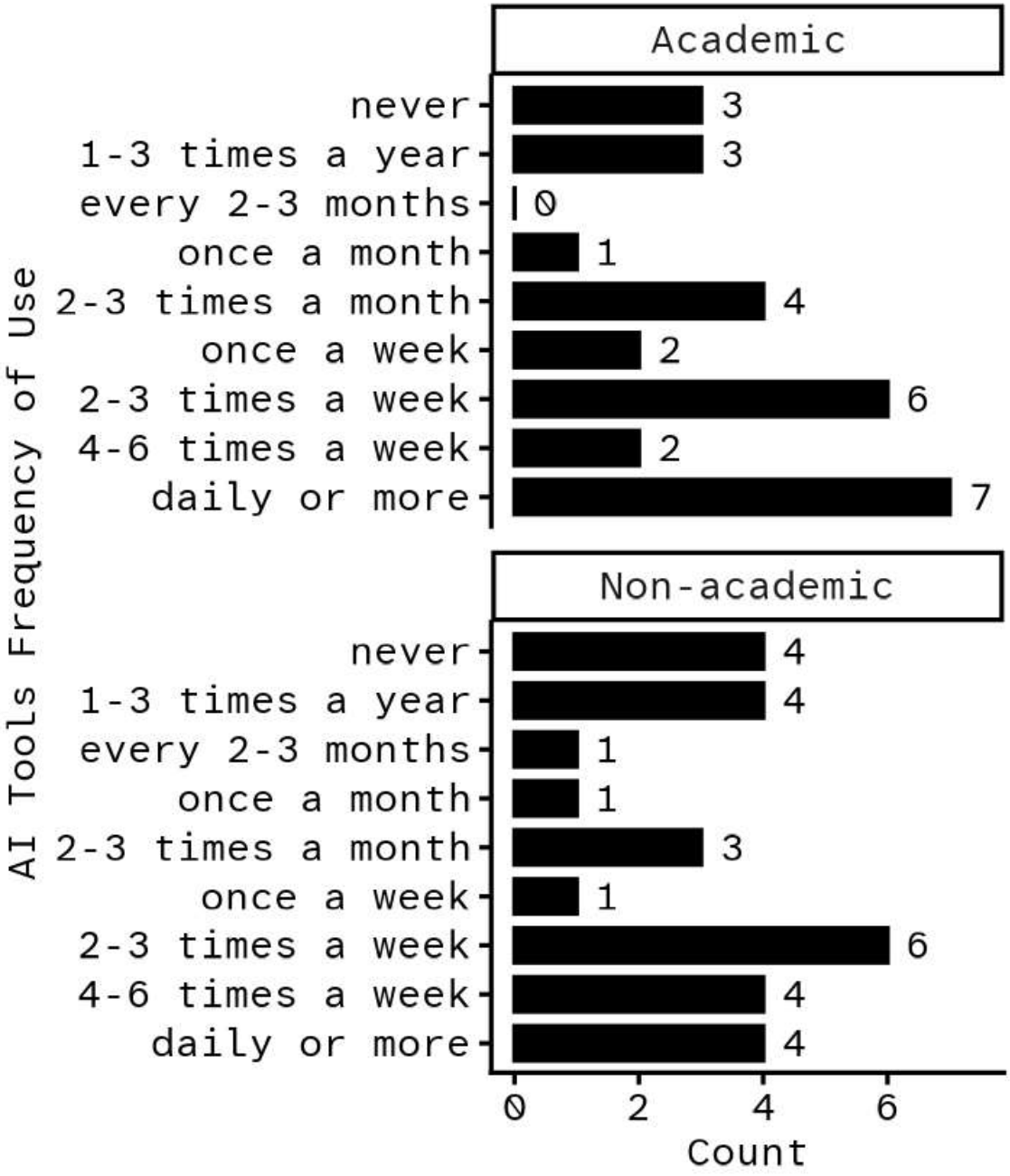
AI generated responses were detected through interrater agreement and subsequently removed from analysis.

Figure 3. Count of Usage and Familiarity with AI Tools in 2025, Ordered by Academic Use



Note. The list of AI tool names presented to the participants was non-exhaustive; the research team accumulated this list via their personal knowledge of AI tools, word of mouth, and by searching for lists of academic and non-academic AI tools online.

Figure 4. Frequency of AI Tool Use



Note. For academic tasks, daily or more frequent use was most common, followed closely by 2–3 times a week. For non-academic tasks, use was most commonly reported as 2–3 times a week. Across both task types, responses spanned the full range from never to daily, but among participants who used AI tools at all, more frequent use predominated.

Table I. A Count of Neurotypes Disclosed by Participants (Expanded)

Recoding	***n***
ADHD	30
Autism	19
Dyslexia	11
OCD	5
Dyspraxia	2
ADD	1
Anxiety	1
Autistic Traits	1
Mood (unspecified)	1

Note. Whilst this table counts neurotypes individually, some participants disclosed multiple co-occurring neurotypes e.g. ADHD, Autism, and Dyslexia.

ADD was aggregated into ADHD, and Autistic Traits was aggregated into Autism in the article.

Table 5. AI Task Categories That Do Not Map to the BRIEF Executive Function Model

Based on:

Gioia, G. A., Isquith, P. K., Retzlaff, P. D., & Espy, K. A. (2002). Confirmatory Factor Analysis of the Behavior Rating Inventory of Executive Function (BRIEF) in a Clinical Sample. *Child Neuropsychology*, *8*(4), 249–257. https://doi.org/10.1076/chin.8.4.249.13513

The following participant quotes reflect generative/creative thinking, knowledge transfer, lookup behaviour, semantic retrieval, or domain-specific reasoning—processes the BRIEF was not designed to capture.

New Category	**Rationale**	**Participant Quotes (All)**
Creative Thinking	Generating novel ideas, imagery, or fictional content—a divergent-thinking process, not an executive-control function like starting (Initiate) or holding information in mind (Working Memory). Moved out of Initiate because nothing in the data confirms people brainstorm because starting is hard.	• generating fun images • design a new avatar for use on email • generating funny images to send to my friends • marketing ideas • titles for essays/posters • logo creation • Inspiration for project • ideas for day to day life • give me some ideas on some of my project stuff • drafting a short story about a D&D character • craft me some ideas for my dnd campaign • Creative writing • DnD role play • building prototypes
Conceptual Explanation / Learning Support	Being taught or shown how something works—knowledge transfer, not cognitive flexibility. Previously forced under Shift; only "finding new ways to use Excel" and "Translating text into English" involve genuine reframing and stayed in Shift.	• instructions on how to use Microsoft apps • explaining basic concepts • understanding and explanation of new skills eg trying to learn R • Explaining concepts that use complex language I struggle reading • explaining information • show strengths/risks of using AI (teaching students) • helping explain concepts I didnt understand

New Category	Rationale	Participant Quotes (All)
		• using Pivot tables • technology explanations (Wifi Access point) • explaining complex ideas in a simple way • learning about certain complicated topics • Finding new ways to use Excel • Learning new languages
Recommendations for places, things, plans, food	Requesting a curated option (a place, a course, a flight, a recipe) rather than building and sequencing a plan. No goal-sequencing occurs — closer to a search-engine substitute than to Plan.	• Reccomendations for sightseeing walking routes on city breaks • looking for free courses online • hotel boookings • flight booking • Recommending recipes around my allergies • Recipes • Meal plans • helping me decide what to have for dinner
Information Seeking / Tutorials / Curiosity-driven questions	Open-ended factual or advice-seeking questions with no task to complete — semantic memory retrieval, not executive control. Includes "finding synonyms" (lexical retrieval, not self-monitoring) and "suggestions for support for autistic people" (informational, not emotional regulation).	• Questions • answering questions that are hard to phrase for a google search • dates in history • attaining general knowledge • answering questions • Ask questions, e.g. what does x mean • curiosity about hypothetical questions • video game tips • suggestions for fun facts about myself • education rankings • advices • general day to day questions • suggestions for support for autistic people • getting useful Information • Diagnosing a disease

New Category	Rationale	Participant Quotes (All)
		• Improving customer satisfaction • getting information regarding my coursework at school
Unspecified	Too vague to assign meaningfully to any cognitive category.	• performing tasks • entertainment • projects • none • caption writing • For education Purpose • Scripts • Doing Assignment

Appendix D – Phase-1: Acknowledgements

D.1) Miscellaneous software

D.1.1) Qualtrics

The surveys were developed and distributed using Qualtrics survey software (Qualtrics, Provo, UT):

Qualtrics. (2026). *Qualtrics XM Platform* [Computer software]. Qualtrics. https://www.qualtrics.com

D.1.2) Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono Regular font

The Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono Regular font was used to make the letters, numbers, and characters in the figures more legible:

Scott, E., Eiswerth, M., Boman, L., & Petrosky, T. (2020). *Atkinson Hyperlegible Font* (Version 1.02) [Computer software]. Braille Institute of America Inc. https://www.brailleinstitute.org/freefont/

D.2) R Packages & Software: quant-analysis_redacted (folder)

Citations and references were generated using the R package "grateful". The "quant-analysis_redacted" folder contains the analysis code, inputs, and outputs for the quantitative analysis conducted during Phase-1.

R packages used

Package	Version	Citation
base	4.6.0	R Core Team (2026)
grateful	0.3.0	Rodriguez-Sanchez and Jackson (2025)
qualtRics	3.3.0	Ginn et al. (2026)
showtext	0.9.8	Qiu (2026)
showtextdb	3.0	Qiu and See file AUTHORS for details. (2020)
sysfonts	0.8.9	Qiu and See file AUTHORS for details. (2024)
tidytext	0.4.3	Silge and Robinson (2016)
tidyverse	2.0.0	Wickham et al. (2019)

You can paste this paragraph directly in your report:

We used R v. 4.6.0 (R Core Team 2026) and the following R packages: grateful v. 0.3.0 (Rodriguez-Sanchez and Jackson 2025), qualtRics v. 3.3.0 (Ginn et al. 2026), showtext v. 0.9.8 (Qiu 2026), showtextdb v. 3.0 (Qiu and See file AUTHORS for details. 2020), sysfonts v. 0.8.9 (Qiu and See file AUTHORS for details. 2024), tidytext v. 0.4.3 (Silge and Robinson 2016), tidyverse v. 2.0.0 (Wickham et al. 2019).

Package citations

Ginn, Jasper, Joseph O'Brien, Julia Silge, and Adam Pilipshen. 2026. *qualtRics: Download "Qualtrics" Survey Data*. https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.qualtRics.

Qiu, Yixuan. 2026. *showtext: Using Fonts More Easily in r Graphs*. https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.showtext.

Qiu, Yixuan, and authors/contributors of the included fonts. See file AUTHORS for details. 2020. *showtextdb: Font Files for the "showtext" Package*. https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.showtextdb.

Qiu, Yixuan, and authors/contributors of the included fonts. See file AUTHORS for details. 2024. *sysfonts: Loading Fonts into r*. https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.sysfonts.

R Core Team. 2026. *R: A Language and Environment for Statistical Computing*. R Foundation for Statistical Computing. https://doi.org/10.32614/R.manuals.

Rodriguez-Sanchez, Francisco, and Connor P. Jackson. 2025. *grateful: Facilitate Citation of R Packages*. https://pakillo.github.io/grateful/.

Silge, Julia, and David Robinson. 2016. “tidytext: Text Mining and Analysis Using Tidy Data Principles in r.” *JOSS* 1 (3). https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.00037.

Wickham, Hadley, Mara Averick, Jennifer Bryan, et al. 2019. “Welcome to the tidyverse.” *Journal of Open Source Software* 4 (43): 1686. https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.01686.

D.3) R Packages & Software: Qual-analysis_redacted (folder)

Citations and references were generated using the R package "grateful". The "Qual-analysis_redacted" folder contains the analysis code, inputs, and outputs for the qualitative analysis conducted during Phase-1. This includes the open text response output files assessed to detect AI generated responses via interrater agreement by Helena Paterson and Jade Burke.

R packages used

Package	Version	Citation
base	4.6.0	R Core Team (2026)
grateful	0.3.0	Rodriguez-Sanchez and Jackson (2025)
openxlsx	4.2.8.1	Schauberger and Walker (2025)
tidyverse	2.0.0	Wickham et al. (2019)

You can paste this paragraph directly in your report:

We used R v. 4.6.0 (R Core Team 2026) and the following R packages: grateful v. 0.3.0 (Rodriguez-Sanchez and Jackson 2025), openxlsx v. 4.2.8.1 (Schauberger and Walker 2025), tidyverse v. 2.0.0 (Wickham et al. 2019).

Package citations

R Core Team. 2026. *R: A Language and Environment for Statistical Computing*. R Foundation for Statistical Computing. https://doi.org/10.32614/R.manuals.

Rodriguez-Sanchez, Francisco, and Connor P. Jackson. 2025. *grateful: Facilitate Citation of R Packages*. https://pakillo.github.io/grateful/.

Schauberger, Philipp, and Alexander Walker. 2025. *openxlsx: Read, Write and Edit Xlsx Files*. https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.openxlsx.

Wickham, Hadley, Mara Averick, Jennifer Bryan, et al. 2019. "Welcome to the tidyverse." *Journal of Open Source Software* 4 (43): 1686. https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.01686.